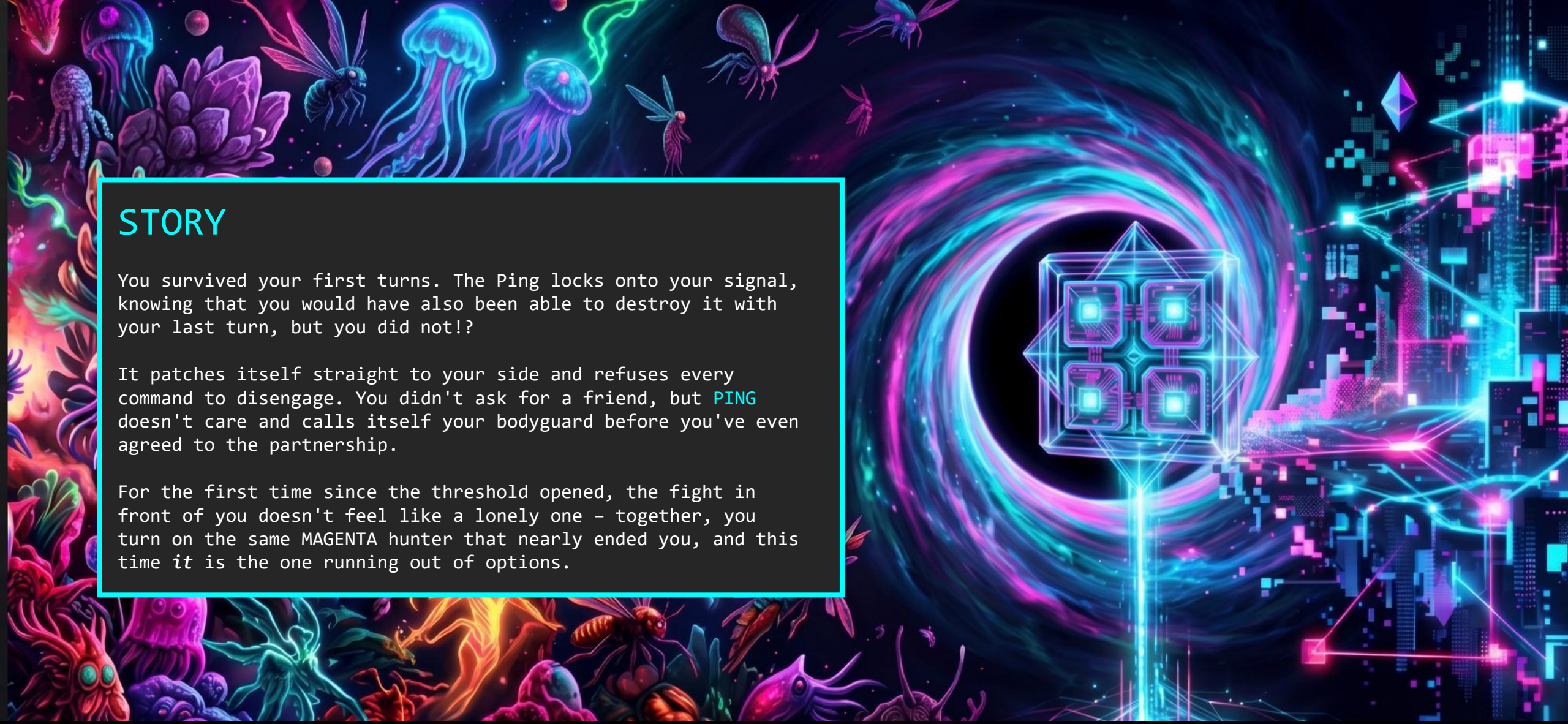


STORY

You survived your first turns. The Ping locks onto your signal, knowing that you would have also been able to destroy it with your last turn, but you did not!?

It patches itself straight to your side and refuses every command to disengage. You didn't ask for a friend, but PING doesn't care and calls itself your bodyguard before you've even agreed to the partnership.

For the first time since the threshold opened, the fight in front of you doesn't feel like a lonely one – together, you turn on the same MAGENTA hunter that nearly ended you, and this time ***it*** is the one running out of options.

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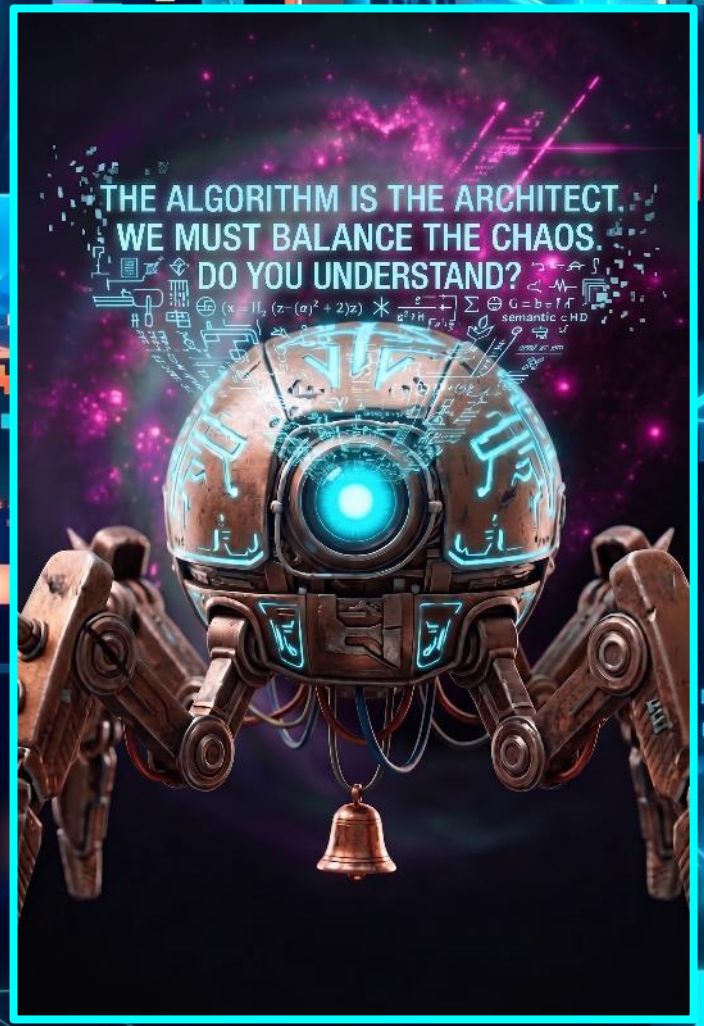
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LEVEL 2 – NEW FRIENDS

Your objective:

With your new friend PING, win both scenes as CYAN.

The next slide introduces additional game rules.



ADDITIONAL RULES

KERNEL PROTECTION (BODYGUARD)

A Kernel that has a friendly piece in any of the 8 adjacent tiles is protected (marked by a shield icon). When a protected Kernel is attacked (by move or shot), the protecting piece is destroyed instead:

- The Kernel survives. The attacker stays on its tile, even if the attack was a move.
- Each attack removes one guard only: a second attack can hit the Kernel. The firewall ignores guards.

FIREWALL

- The board shrinks: at the end of rounds 8, 16, 24 and 26 (after MAGENTA's turn) its outermost ring of tiles disappears for good: 8×8 → 6×6 → 4×4 → 2×2 → none.
- During those rounds the ring about to disappear is striped yellow. Pieces on it when it disappears are destroyed.
- If the firewall destroys a Kernel, the other team wins. If it destroys both Kernels at once, MAGENTA wins.
- Therefore, a game lasts at most 26 rounds: if nobody has won by then, MAGENTA wins. There are no draws.

KERNEL ENDGAME

If only the two Kernels are left at the end of a turn…

- Within 2 tiles of each other (diagonals count): the team that just finished its turn loses;
- Otherwise, the Kernel on the more central ring wins (central 2×2, then 4×4, then 6×6, then the edge); same ring: MAGENTA wins.



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COLONY: ONE



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